



SRIJITH NAIR

SENIOR HR LEADER
AI-DRIVEN HUMAN CAPITAL STRATEGIST

27+ Years | GCC and India | UAE Golden Visa Holder
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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

A board advisory member, doctoral researcher, and transformational Senior HR Leader with 27+ years of full-spectrum Human Capital leadership across the GCC and India. Recognised for architecting people strategies that deliver measurable competitive advantage, spanning enterprise-wide talent and succession frameworks, compensation architecture, HR operations, and regulatory compliance. Brings rare dual fluency as both a practitioner and an innovator: the only HR leader in the region personally architecting 10+ AI agents that automate, predict, and personalise the people function at scale.

Proven across multi-sector environments spanning aviation, banking, financial services, logistics, and retail, with direct accountability for workforces of 25,000+ across UAE, KSA, Oman, Bahrain, and Qatar. A trusted senior HR partner to CEOs and Boards on succession, Saudization strategy, leadership readiness, and AI-powered workforce transformation.

CAREER IMPACT AT A GLANCE

39% Retention improvement across GCC (25,000+ workforce)	100% Board, CEO and N-1 succession compliance	10+ Self-built AI agents deployed in HR function	1M+ SAR Cost optimization via digital learning transformation
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CORE COMPETENCIES

HR Strategy	AI-Powered HR Innovation	Succession and Talent Architecture
Compensation and Benefits Strategy	HR Operations and Shared Services	Saudization and Emiratization Compliance
Strategic Workforce Planning	Organisational Development and Culture	Employee Relations and Policy Design
Leadership and High-Potential Development	HR Analytics and People Intelligence	Board-Level Advisory and Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SAL, Saudi Arabian Airlines Group

July 2025 to Present

Director, Human Capital and AI Strategy (HR Projects)

Appointed to lead the Group's strategic HR transformation agenda spanning succession planning, HR strategy, performance management, AI deployment, and workforce capability building across the Group.

- **Succession Architecture:** Led enterprise-wide C-suite and critical role succession planning using 9-box grids, readiness analytics, and predictive bench-strength modelling, aligned to the Group's 2030 growth trajectory.
- **HR Strategy and NRC Presentations:** Developed and presented comprehensive HR strategy and workforce analytics reports to the NRC (Nomination and Remuneration Committee) and Board, translating people data into strategic governance insights and enabling informed decision-making at the highest level.

- ▶ **Performance Management:** Designed and executed the Group's performance management framework, aligning individual KPIs to organisational objectives, calibrating ratings through structured review cycles, and embedding a high-performance culture across business units.
- ▶ **HR Analytics and Intelligence:** Established a centralised Talent Intelligence ecosystem providing the CHRO and Board with real-time dashboards on leadership performance, flight-risk indicators, and readiness gaps.
- ▶ **AI Agent Development:** Engineered 10+ custom AI agents built entirely in-house at zero external cost, including an organisation-wide employee engagement agent that captures real-time sentiment and surfaces actionable people insights, reducing dependence on third-party vendors and accelerating HR's digital transformation.
- ▶ **Leadership Acceleration:** Designed high-impact development journeys integrating experiential learning, bridge roles, executive coaching, and global leadership programmes for senior leaders and HIPOs.
- ▶ **Employee Development:** Launched a skills taxonomy framework built on structured skills gap analysis across critical roles, integrated AI coaching capabilities, and deployed a digital learning ecosystem that optimised learning costs by 1 million SAR while expanding reach and personalisation.
- ▶ **Capability Building:** Led capability-building collaboration with global institutes to embed strategic, digital, and operational excellence in leadership curricula aligned to aviation and logistics transformation.
- ▶ **M and A HR Integration:** Spearheaded internal communications and HR strategy for SAL's acquisition of Aviapartner Liege, ensuring workforce continuity, change communication, and cultural integration.

Dubai Islamic Bank, UAE

June 2023 to June 2025

Centre of Excellence: Talent Management and Leadership Development

Full accountability for the bank's Talent Management and Leadership Development agenda across 8,000+ employees, with direct interface to CHRO and Executive Committee.

- ▶ **Strategic Talent Alignment:** Achieved 100% Board, CEO, and N-1 succession compliance by designing and executing a rigorous succession framework aligned to CBUAE mandates, ensuring uninterrupted leadership continuity across all critical roles.
- ▶ **Emiratization and Compliance:** Developed a comprehensive Emiratization talent development strategy, steering UAE National Talent initiatives and building targeted development programmes for Emirati high-potentials.
- ▶ **HR Tech Innovation:** Sole architect and developer of an AI-powered automation solution leveraging LLMs to streamline Talent Management and IDP processes, reducing HR processing time by 60% and eliminating manual intervention.
- ▶ **Career Architecture:** Created competency and career pathing frameworks enabling structured employee growth and succession readiness across business units.
- ▶ **Leadership Development:** Curated and executed targeted leadership development programmes for senior talent, integrating psychometric assessment (Hogan, MBTI, Predictive Index) into development planning.

Landmark Group, UAE

March 2022 to May 2023

General Manager, Group Talent and Succession | Leadership Development and Special Projects

Group-wide people leadership for 25,000+ employees across UAE, KSA, Oman, Bahrain, and Qatar, overseeing Talent Management, Succession, Learning and OD, and Cultural Transformation.

- ▶ **Retention Impact:** Drove a 39% retention improvement across a 25,000+ GCC workforce through a data-driven talent retention strategy combining stay interviews, career pathing, and manager capability uplift.
- ▶ **Succession Management:** Led GCC-wide succession management for critical roles, building data-driven succession plans and working directly with the Leadership Team to close talent gaps.
- ▶ **Emiratization Strategy:** Stewarded the Emiratization and localisation strategy, designing structured UAE national development tracks aligned to regulatory targets.
- ▶ **Cultural Transformation:** Led cultural transformation initiative, curating frameworks, tools, and practices that revamped organisational effectiveness across a geographically dispersed retail group.
- ▶ **OD and Impact Analytics:** Designed and implemented TM and OD impact measurement frameworks with KPIs and dashboards to track effectiveness of people processes at Group level.
- ▶ **Award:** Received the People Excellence Award (2022) for transformational impact on talent outcomes across the Group.

Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC Ltd, India

March 2017 to February 2022

Head, Talent Acquisition | Talent Management | Performance Management | Learning and OD

Full ownership of the people agenda across talent acquisition, talent management, performance, learning, and organisational development for a leading asset management company.

- ▶ **Full HR Function Leadership:** Built and led the end-to-end talent function covering acquisition, management, learning, and OD, heading a team of 12 HR professionals.
- ▶ **Compensation and Benchmarking:** Designed and managed compensation benchmarking using market data, ensuring competitive pay positioning and pay equity across bands.

- ▶ **Performance Management:** Instituted a structured performance management cycle linking individual goals to business outcomes, with calibration rigour across leadership and frontline populations.
- ▶ **Recognition:** Received CEO Excellence Award (2017 and 2018) and Emerging Leader Award (2019) for sustained HR innovation and business impact.
- ▶ **Engagement and Culture:** Executed enterprise-wide engagement, diversity, and culture initiatives, recognised as Best L and D Mind at India World HRD Congress (2017 to 2018).

Earlier Career

- ▶ Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance, India | Group Head, Learning and Development | 2015 to 2017
- ▶ Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance, India | Zonal Training and Talent Development Head, South | 2008 to 2015
- ▶ Bharti AXA, India | Distribution HR and Training Head, Tamil Nadu | 2006 to 2008
- ▶ Max New York Life Insurance, India | Training Manager | 2003 to 2006
- ▶ SriLankan Airlines, India | Manager, Airport | 2001 to 2003
- ▶ Jet Airways, India | Assistant Manager, Commercial | 1998 to 2001

EDUCATION AND ACADEMIC CREDENTIALS

Doctorate (AI and HR Strategy)	ESGCI Paris Business School	2027 (in progress)
Post Graduate Diploma in AI for Leaders	Texas McCombs School of Business, USA	2021
MSc, Applied Psychology	Bharathiar University	2018
MBA, Human Resource Management	Sikkim Manipal University	2015
PG Diploma, Human Resources	Symbiosis Institute of Management Studies	2014
Bachelor's degree in Commerce	Madras University	1999

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

AI and Digital Certifications

Claude AI Skills Certification (x2)	Anthropic Academia	2024
Agentic AI Professional Certification	Skill Up EdTech	2024
Building AI Agents using RAG and LangChain	IBM	2024
Generative AI for HR Professionals	IBM	2024
Post Graduate Diploma in AI and Machine Learning	Texas McCombs School of Business, USA	2021

Psychometric, Assessment and Coaching Certifications

Hogan Assessment Certification	Hogan Institute	2022
Talent Spotting Certification	Korn Ferry	2019
MBTI Practitioner	The Myers and Briggs Foundation	2018
Certified Predictive Index Practitioner	The Predictive Index	2017
Talent Development and Succession Management Practitioner	Tata Institute of Social Sciences	2019
Certified Performance Coach	Inside Out Development	2016
Brain-Based Coaching Certification	NeuroLeadership Institute	2017
Certified Happiness Coach	Berkeley Institute of Wellbeing	2020

Facilitation and Training Credentials

Certified Facilitator and Trainer	Internationally Accredited
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AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Global Laureate in HR	The Leadership Federation	2024
People Excellence Award	Landmark Group	2022
Emerging Leader Award	Aditya Birla Group	2019
Best Customer Service Initiative, I CARE	Aditya Birla Group	2019
CEO Excellence Award	Aditya Birla Group	2017 and 2018
Best L and D Mind, India	World HRD Congress	2018

ADVISORY, RESEARCH AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **Research:** Doctoral Researcher in AI and Workforce Strategy at ESGCI Paris Business School (2027), building an evidence-based framework for AI integration in human capital management.
- **Academic:** Visiting Faculty at UCLA, shaping the next generation of HR and organisational leaders through applied research and executive education.
- **Speaker:** Speaker and keynote presenter on AI-driven HR transformation, future of work, and GCC talent strategy at international forums and leadership conferences.
- **Board Advisory:** Board Advisor on people risk, succession readiness, and HR digital transformation, with direct experience presenting to NRC and board-level governance bodies.
- **Author:** Author (in progress for publication) of salary negotiation guides and career development frameworks, including the WORTH Framework and Negotiation Stack methodology.

KEY SKILLS AND DOMAIN EXPERTISE

HR Strategy and Leadership	Full-function senior HR ownership, people strategy, board reporting, HR governance
Compensation and Benefits	Korn Ferry grading, market benchmarking, pay equity, total rewards, GCC comp norms
GCC Regulatory Fluency	Saudization / Nitaqat, Emiratization, GOSI, SOCPA, CBUAE, Vision 2030 alignment
Talent and Succession	9-box grid, bench-strength analytics, C-suite succession, HIPO identification
HR Operations and HRIS	HR shared services, process automation, HRIS integration, digital HR transformation
AI and HR Tech	10+ custom AI agents, LLM automation, predictive analytics, intelligent dashboards
Learning and OD	Leadership development, capability frameworks, cultural transformation, change management
Facilitation and Training	Certified facilitator and trainer, executive workshop design, cohort-based learning
Employee Relations	GCC workforce relations, conflict resolution, policy design, ER frameworks